

Mitsue Kanko — Workforce & Relocation Strategy

"Rewild a mountain, power an AI data center, and rebuild a village — one job, one place, one 25-year story."

Doubling (and eventually tripling) the 御杖村森林組合 (Mitsue Kanko) crew is the single lever that unlocks the whole forest→energy plan (see `mitsue_forest_workforce_energy_plan.md`). This document sets out how to attract the right people — **mission first, money as the enabler** — using Japan's existing forestry and relocation subsidy stack.

The core thesis: **subsidies get us to parity; the mission is what actually attracts and retains**. Grants remove every financial reason *not* to come; the mission is the reason *to* come — and it is the fix for the well-known 3-year retention problem of relocation schemes.

1. The pull — a three-pillar mission

The ordinary rural-forestry pitch ("come do sugi thinning in a depopulating village") is a hard sell. Ours is categorically different: the same job restores a forest, powers computation, and revives a village. Each pillar widens the funnel to a different community.

🌿 Reforest — restore a living native forest

Not "cut trees" but the opposite: **convert dark, lifeless sugi monoculture into living native broadleaf forest** — コナラ / クスギ for wildlife forage, bringing back birds, insects, and balance; protecting watersheds and reducing landslide risk. It is a **multi-decade legacy you can physically walk through**: *the forest our ancestors planted for timber, remade into the forest we leave our descendants*. This is the emotional core, and it pulls **ecology- and conservation-minded people** who would never answer a "forestry worker" ad but would move to *rewild a mountain*.

⚡ Power — energy + a community AI data center

The same forest work **literally powers computation** — biomass CHP, salt-battery storage, a village-owned data center. Frontier technology, not analog forestry. Pulls **purpose-driven technologists and engineers**.

🏡 Revive — rebuild a village with a future

A depopulating mountain village given a genuine next chapter — jobs, families, energy self-sufficiency, disaster resilience. Pulls **U/I-turn returnees** who want rural life *with* a future, not nostalgia.

Why the triad matters: it is the project's whole thesis in one job — *forest restoration* → *distributed energy* → *community-owned compute*. Most rural jobs offer one thread; this offers all three, woven together. That breadth is both the attraction and the retention glue.

2. Who we are recruiting (personas)

Persona	Drawn by	Reach through
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Persona	Drawn by	Reach through
Conservationists / ecologists (20s–40s)	Reforest pillar — rewilding, biodiversity	Conservation NGOs, rewilding communities, ecology programmes
Purpose-driven technologists / engineers (20s–30s)	Power pillar — energy + data center; city-burnout	Climate-tech communities, the project's network (Ray Ozzie / Joi Ito reach), media
U/I-turn returnees & young families	Revive pillar — rural life with a future	移住 fairs, JOIN, prefectural relocation portals
Forestry + CS/engineering students	The rare crossover of all three	University forestry & CS departments, internships

These people do **not** read job boards for "森林組合作業員." The formal listing is necessary (for subsidy eligibility) but the real reach is the mission story through communities and media.

3. The stack — enabling subsidies (2026, verified)

Scheme	Funder → recipient	Value	Role
緑の雇用 (Green Employment)	林野庁 → the co-op	Wage-equivalent + OJT training subsidy for new forestry recruits (~3-yr フォレストワーカー)	Core lever — removes the co-op's cost/risk of taking on green workers
地域おこし協力隊	総務省 (特別交付税) → via 御杖村	~¥320万/yr 報償費 + ~¥200万/yr activity (~¥520万 total), up to 3 yrs; + up to ¥100万 startup grant	~3 yrs of funded posts that convert to permanent co-op hires
移住支援金 (Relocation grant)	国+県+町 → the mover	Household up to ¥100万 + up to ¥100万 per child (<18); single ¥60万	For movers from Tokyo 23-ku to 御杖 in a registered co-op job
緑の青年就業準備給付金	林野庁 → pre-entrants	up to ~¥155万/yr while training	Feeder pipeline from forestry schools
空き家バンク + village housing	御杖村	vacant-house match + renovation support	Solves the housing half of relocation
Project top-up	project (energy revenue / MoE 交付金)	signing bonus, reno, family support	Differentiator vs. other villages

Illustrative stacked package — one relocating family

地域おこし協力隊 (~¥520万/yr × 3 yrs) *or* **direct co-op hire + 緑の雇用 training subsidy** → **plus 移住支援金 ¥100万 + ¥100万/child** → **plus akiya housing + project top-up**. A genuinely competitive package — and after the 協力隊 term, a permanent Mitsue Kanko job is waiting (the retention fix most villages lack).

4. What has to happen — setup actions (Phase 0–1)

1. **Mitsue Kanko registers as a 緑の雇用 実施事業体** and posts jobs on Nara's matching site. *Unlocks both 緑の雇用 and 移住支援金 eligibility.* — Owner: co-op + project.

2. 御杖村 **creates** 地域おこし協力隊 **posts** framed around the forest→energy project (forestry + CHP/chip ops + tree-survey/eco-tourism). *A mayor/village decision — ties directly into the 官民連携 angle.* — Owner: Representative Director + village.
3. **Confirm** 御杖村 / 奈良県 **participate in** 移住支援金 and are on the matching site. — Owner: project + village.
4. **Design the roles as multi-skill** (forestry + energy + field-tech), not single-trade — essential for attraction and retention.
5. **Build the mission-story reach**: landing page, media angle, and outreach through the project's network and climate-tech / conservation communities.

5. Honest caveats

- **協力隊 3-year retention is a known nationwide weak spot.** The fix is a real permanent job and business model waiting at the end — which is exactly what this project provides. Do not create posts without that landing place.
- **移住支援金 has clawback** if the recipient leaves the area within ~5 years — set expectations honestly.
- **Roles must be multi-skill.** A single sugi-thinning job will not retain a young family; the reforest + energy + tech breadth is what holds people.
- **The mission must be real, not marketing.** These personas detect greenwashing instantly — the reforestation must genuinely prioritise native ecology (see `project_reforestation_principle`), not just fuel.

Sources / 出典

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- 林野庁 新規就業者育成推進事業 — https://www.rinya.maff.go.jp/j/supply/hojyo/02koubo_1/02mhk0101.html
- 地方創生「移住支援金」 — https://www.chisou.go.jp/sousei/ijyu_shienkin.html
- 総務省「地域おこし協力隊」 — https://www.soumu.go.jp/main_sosiki/jichi_gyousei/c-gyousei/02gyousei08_03000066.html
- Related: `mitsue_forest_workforce_energy_plan.md`, 御杖村森林組合 Report, forest working-group issue #13